MILITARY SPECIFICATION

TONGS, MATERIAL LIFTING

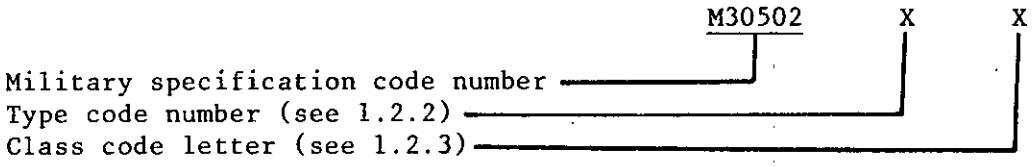
This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers double-lever horizontal and vertical material lifting tongs.

1.2 Classification. Tongs shall be the following types and classes and shall be designated by the applicable definitive military specification part number (see 6.2 and 6.6).

1.2.1 Definitive military specification part number. Tongs covered by this specification shall be designated in the following form (see 6.2):



Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: USA Mobility Equipment Research and Development Command, ATTN: DRDME-DS, Fort Belvoir, VA 22060 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

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1.2.2 Type. The type is identified by a single digit (see table I).

Table I. Type code number.

Code number	Type	Rated capacity (SWL) 1/ lb (min)
1	Type I - I-Beam	4000
2	Type II - Rail	8000
3	Type III - Barrel	500
4	Type IV - Box	2000
5	Type V - Timber	

1/ Safe working load.

1.2.3 Class. The class shall be identified by a single letter (see table II).

Table II. Class code letter (Type V only).

Code letter		Rated Capacity (SWL) lb (min)
A	Class 1 - 36-inch max. opening	1000
B	Class 2 - 14-inch max. opening	2000

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications and standards. Unless otherwise specified, the following specifications and standards of the issue listed in that issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) specified in the solicitation form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

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SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

FF-B-575	- Bolts, Hexagon and Square.
FF-N-836	- Nut: Square, Hexagon, Cap, Slotted, Castle, Knurled, Welding and Single Ball Seat.
FF-W-84	- Washers, Lock, (Spring).
RR-C-271	- Chains and Attachments, Welded and Weldless.
PPP-B-601	- Boxes, Wood, Cleated Plywood.
PPP-B-621	- Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-T-60	- Tape: Packaging, Waterproof.

MILITARY

MIL-P-116	- Preservation, Methods of.
MIL-B-121	- Barrier Material, Greaseproofed, Waterproofed, Flexible.
MIL-G-20241	- Gasket Material, Wool Felt, Impregnated, Adhesive, Pressure-Sensitive.
MIL-P-23377	- Primer Coatings: Epoxy-Polyamide, Chemical and Solvent Resistant.
MIL-S-81733	- Sealing and Coating Compound, Corrosion Inhibitive.

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-H28	- Screw-Thread Standards for Federal Services.

MILITARY

MIL-STD-22	- Welded Joint Design.
MIL-STD-105	- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspectation by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	- Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-130	- Identification Marking of US Military Property.
MIL-STD-889	- Dissimilar Metals.
MIL-STD-1188	- Commercial Packaging of Supplies and Equipment.

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MS24665	- Pin, Cotter (Split).
MS35810	- Pin, Straight, Headed (Clevis Pin) Steel, Cadmium or Zinc Plated.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. The issues of the documents which are indicated as DoD adopted shall be the issue listed in the current DoDISS and the supplement thereto, if applicable.

AMERICAN NATIONAL STANDARDS INSTITUTE (ANSI)

ANSI/ASTM A 108 - Steel Bars, Carbon, Cold-Finished, Standard Quality.
ANSI/ASTM A 331 - Steel Bars, Alloy, Cold-Finished.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American National Standards Institute, Inc, 1430 Broadway, New York, NY 10018.)

(Industry association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, the text of this specification shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Description. The tongs shall be as specified herein and similar, as applicable, to those shown in figures 1 through 6 (see 6.4). Tong levers shall cause the gripping jaws to exert an ever-tightening grip on material being lifted to insure safety against slipping while under load. Major differences in types of tongs (see 1.2) depend upon the individual capacities and upon the nature of the material to be lifted. The tongs shall be such that parts subject to fracture, distortion, or excessive wear may be replaced. All parts shall be provided with means to prevent accidental disengagement during normal operating conditions.

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3.2 First article. When specified (see 6.2), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3 and 6.3).

3.3 Material. When the material for components of the tongs is not specified, it shall be either carbon or low-alloy steel conforming to ANSI/ASTM A 108, or ANSI/ASTM A 331, form round or flat, as applicable (see 6.5).

3.3.1 Material deterioration and control. The tongs shall be fabricated from compatible materials, inherently corrosion resistant or treated to provide protection against the various forms of corrosion and deterioration that may be encountered in any of the applicable storage and operating environment to which the item may be exposed.

3.3.1.1 Dissimilar metals. Dissimilar metals, as defined in MIL-STD-889, shall be electrically insulated from one another to minimize or prevent galvanic corrosion. Insulation shall be provided by an insulating barrier such as a coat of epoxy primer conforming to MIL-P-23377, or corrosion inhibiting sealant conforming to MIL-S-81733 or chromate tape conforming to MIL-G-20241. Protection against any galvanic corrosion could also be obtained by exclusion of the electrolyte if feasible.

3.3.1.2 Identification of materials and finishes. The contractor shall identify the specific material, material finish or treatment for use with components and sub-components, and shall make information available, upon request, to the contracting officer or designated representative.

3.4 Threads. Threads shall conform to FED-STD-H28. The American National fine thread series shall be used for threaded parts less than 1/4 inch in diameter. The Unified or American National coarse thread series shall be used for threaded parts 1/4 inch in diameter and larger; however, the American National fine thread series may be employed for these sizes when applicable.

3.5 Construction. The basic construction of the tongs shall be as indicated for the type(s) shown on the applicable figure(s) (see 6.4). The individual components shall be as specified herein. Tongs shall withstand the tests specified in 4.5.2 without damage.

3.5.1 Projections. Projections on the external portions of the tongs shall be held to a minimum. Use of pins, heads of rivets, nuts, and other portions of each assembly shall minimize the possibility of catching or hooking on adjacent objects.

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3.5.2 Welding. For types III and IV tongs (see 1.2), where welded joints are used, welding shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-22. The surfaces of parts to be welded shall be free from rust, scale, paint, grease, or mill scale that can be removed by chipping and wire brushing, and other foreign matter. Welds shall transmit stress without permanent deformation or failure when the parts connected by the welds are subjected to proof loading.

3.6 Lifting capacities. Each type of tong shall have a rated capacity as specified in 1.2, and respective tongs shall lift their rated capacities (SWL-lbs) repetitively, with sustained loads, without evidence of failure, deformation, distortion, binding, or any other evidence of damage affecting the function/operation of the tongs. When subject to lifting a proof load of 2-1/2 times their respective rated SWL, the tongs shall show no evidence of failure, deformation, distortion, binding, or any other evidence of damage affecting the function/operation of the tongs.

3.7 Finish. The finish of tong components, when not specified, shall be either zinc coated or self-colored.

3.8 Identification marking. Tongs shall be identified in accordance with MIL-STD-130, in a manner that will not interfere with the mechanism or opreation of the tongs. Identification shall include the following:

TONGS, MATERIAL LIFTING:*

NSN:**

MFR:***

RATED CAPACITY:****LBS.

US

* List type, by name, i.e., I-beam, rail, etc.
** List applicable National Stock Number (NSN).
*** List manufacturer's name.
**** List rated capacity (SWL) as specified in 1.2.

3.9 Interchangeability. All parts having the same part number shall be functionally and dimensionally interchangeable. Interchangeable parts are defined as two or more like parts possessing such functional and physical

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characteristics as to be equivalent in performance and durability and capable of being exchanged one for the other without alteration of the parts themselves or of adjoining parts, except for adjustment, and without selection for fit or performance.

3.10 Detailing of type and class requirements.

3.10.1 Type I. Type I tongs (see figure 1) shall be designed for lifting or transporting steel I-beams in a horizontal position, and shall have a 0- to 8-inch jaw opening. The I-beam tongs shall consist essentially of two levers, two connecting links, a lifting ring, and a lever pin.

3.10.1.1 Connecting links. The connecting links of the I-beam tongs shall conform to RR-C-271, type II attachment.

3.10.1.2 Lifting ring. The lifting ring shall conform to RR-C-271, type IV attachment, and shall have an opening (ID) of not less than 3-1/2 inches.

3.10.1.3 Lever pin. The lever pin shall conform to MS35810 and shall be cadmium-plated. An appropriate size cotter pin, in accordance with MS24665, cadmium-plated, shall be used with the lever pin in final assembly of the tongs.

3.10.2 Type II. Type II tongs (see figure 2) shall be designed for lifting/transporting steel railroad rails in a horizontal position. The rail tongs shall consist essentially of two gripping levers, two gripping pads, two lever straps, a lifting shackle, a lifting shackle pin, and three lever pins. The jaws opening range of the rail tongs shall be 0 to 5 inches.

3.10.2.1 Gripping levers. Gripping levers shall be capable of gripping all steel rails within the jaw opening range of 0 to 5 inches.

3.10.2.2 Gripping pads. Gripping pads shall have serrations or machined diamond face of shape and depth to assure a positive grip, and shall have a minimum Rockwell C hardness of 50. Means shall be provided for the pads to swivel in a direction which contributes to alinement of the clamp with the direction of pull.

3.10.2.3 Lever straps. Lever straps shall permit operation of the gripping levers as specified in 3.10.2.1 and shall have openings to receive the lever pins and the shackle pin.

3.10.2.4 Shackle. The lifting shackle with pin shall conform to RR-C-271, type IV attachment, class 4. The eye opening (width between eyes) of the shackle shall be not less than 2 inches.

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3.10.2.5 Lever pin. The lever pin shall be as specified in 3.10.1.3.

3.10.3 Type III. Type III tongs (see figure 3) shall be designed for various hoisting devices used in lifting or transporting steel barrels (drums) in a vertical position. Barrel tongs shall consist essentially of lifting arms, drum gripping jaws, and a lifting ring.

3.10.3.1 Lifting arms. Lifting arms shall permit the gripping jaws to grip steel drums within the drum diameter range up to 23-1/2 inches. A hole shall be provided in one end of each arm to receive the lifting ring. The hole shall be of sufficient size to insure free movement of the arms on the lifting ring when hoisting tension is applied by the hoisting device. Hoisting tension shall cause an ever-tightening grip on the barrel being lifted.

3.10.3.2 Gripping jaws. Gripping jaws shall be smooth faced, formed to conform to the shape of the drum circumference (see figure 3), and shall be attached to the lifting arms by arc-welding as specified in 3.5.2.

3.10.3.3 Lifting ring. The lifting ring shall conform to RR-C-271, type VI attachment, and shall have an opening (ID) of not more than 3-1/2 inches.

3.10.4 Type IV. Type IV tongs (see figure 4) shall be designed for use with various hoisting devices to lift boxes in a horizontal or vertical position. Box tongs shall be designed with jointed arms which automatically aline gripping jaws flat against the sides of boxes. Removable machined rollers shall be provided in arm links for triangular sling connection. Replaceable machined and hardened steel teeth shall be provided in gripping jaws to insure safe grips and distribute the load to be lifted across the face of jaws. Box tongs shall consist essentially of arms, rollers, arm links, bolts, nuts, washers, cotter pins, arm pins, gripping-jaw pads, and gripping-jaw teeth.

3.10.4.1 Arms. Arm design shall be as specified in 3.10.4. Holes shall be provided in each of the arms to receive arm pins.

3.10.4.2 Rollers. Rollers shall be designed as specified in 3.10.4. Holes shall be provided on centers to permit assembly to arm links by use of a spacer and machine bolt. The circumference of the roller shall be concave, machined from outer edges to center of width with sufficient depth to the concave groove to accommodate cable and to function properly when lifting the specified proof load.

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3.10.4.3 Arm links. Arm links shall be designed to be attached in pairs to the tong arms. Holes shall be provided in each end of the links to receive the flathead arm pins and roller bolts.

3.10.4.4 Bolts and nuts. Bolts shall be hexagonal head, cadmium plated, conforming to FF-B-575, type II; and nuts shall conform to FF-N-836, type II, style 4. Threads on bolts and nuts shall be as specified in 3.4.

3.10.4.5 Lockwashers. Lockwashers used under nuts of roller bolts and gripping teeth shall conform to FF-W-84, class A, style 2, cadmium plated.

3.10.4.6 Lever pin. Lever pins shall be as specified in 3.10.1.3.

3.10.4.7 Gripping-jaw pads. Gripping-jaw pads shall be smooth faced with holes drilled and countersunk to receive gripping-jaw teeth. Two supporting gussets shall be welded on the back surface of the pads. Gussets shall be spaced a sufficient distance apart to permit free turning of rollers.

3.10.4.8 Gripping-jaw teeth. Gripping-jaw teeth shall be designed as specified in 3.10.4. Teeth shall be smooth machine-finished and tapered from a shoulder to a center point. Diameter of shoulder shall be not less than 1/2 inch larger than threaded portion of teeth. Threads shall be as specified in 3.4 and fitted with mated nuts as specified in 3.10.4.4.

3.10.5 Type V. Type V tongs (see figures 5 and 6) shall be designed for carrying timber in a horizontal or vertical position. Timber tongs shall have single-tooth jaw design and shall be the class specified (see 1.2).

3.10.5.1 Class 1. Class 1 timber tongs shall consist essentially of two levers, two lever links, a lifting ring and a lever pin, and shall have a jaw opening range of 0 to 36 inches.

3.10.5.1.1 Levers. Lever design shall be such that eyes and jaw points are given an extra upset to put additional steel at the points of greatest stress. Eyes shall be provided to receive the lever links. Eyes shall be formed by the drop-forge method to give uniformity and maximum strength. An opening to receive the lever pin shall be located at such distance from the links to permit maximum pressure to be exerted on the timber to be lifted when tension is applied by the hoisting device. Hoisting tension to the tongs shall cause an ever-tightening grip on the timber being lifted.

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3.10.5.1.2 Connecting links, lifting ring, and lever pin. Connecting links, lifting ring, and lever pin shall be as specified in 3.10.1.1, 3.10.1.2, and 3.10.1.3.

3.10.5.2 Class 2. Class 2 timber tongs shall consist of two gripping levers, two lever straps, a lifting shackle with pin, and three lever pins, and shall have a jaw opening range of 0 to 14 inches.

3.10.5.2.1 Levers. Lever design shall be such that openings (holes) are provided to receive the lever pin and lever strap pins. The opening to receive the lever pin shall be located at such distance from the lever straps to permit maximum pressure to be exerted on the timber to be lifted when tension is applied by the hoisting device. Hoisting tension to the tongs shall cause an ever-tightening grip on the timber being lifted.

3.10.5.2.2 Lever straps. Lever straps shall permit operation of the gripping levers specified in 3.10.5.2.1 and shall have openings to receive the strap pins and shackle pin.

3.10.5.2.3 Shackle. Lifting shackle and pin shall be as specified in 3.10.2.4.

3.10.5.2.4 Lever pins. Lever pins shall be as specified in 3.10.1.3.

3.11 Workmanship. All components of the tongs shall operate freely and shall not bind or malfunction when lifting loads specified herein. The tongs shall be free of rust, burrs, sharp edges and corners, excessive scale, and surface imperfections. The tongs shall be free of any broken, split, cracked, distorted, inoperative, or malfunctioning components.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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4.1.1 Components and material inspection. The contractor is responsible for insuring that components and materials used are manufactured, examined, and tested in accordance with referenced specifications and standards, as applicable.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).

b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

c. Inspection of packaging (see 4.6).

4.3 First article inspection.

4.3.1 Examination. The first article tongs shall be examined as specified in 4.5.1. Presence of one or more defects shall be cause for rejection.

4.3.2 Tests. The first article tongs shall be tested as specified in 4.5.2. Failure of any test shall be cause for rejection.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection.

4.4.1 Sampling. Sampling for examination and tests shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.4.2 Examination. Samples selected in accordance with 4.4.1 shall be examined for the major and minor defects specified in 4.5.1. AQL shall be 2.5 percent defective for major defects and 6.5 percent defective for minor defects.

4.4.3 Tests. Samples selected in accordance with 4.4.1 shall be tested as specified in 4.5.2.1. AQL shall be 2.5 percent defective.

4.5 Inspection procedure.

4.5.1 Examination. The tongs shall be examined as specified herein for the following defects:

Major

101. Type or class of tongs not as specified.
102. Material not as specified.

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103. Materials are not corrosion resistant or treated to be made corrosion resistant for the applicable storage and operating environment.
104. Dissimilar metals as defined in MIL-STD-889 are not effectively insulated from each other.
105. Contractor does not have documentation available for identification of material, material finishes or treatments.
106. Threaded parts not as specified.
107. Construction/components not as specified or missing.
108. Welding not as specified.
109. Finish not as specified.
110. Dimensions not as specified for jaw opening range or for ID of lifting ring/shackle.
111. Hardness of gripping pads not as specified.
112. Workmanship not as specified.

Minor

201. Interchangeability not as specified.
202. Identification marking missing, incomplete, or illegible.

4.5.2 Tests.

4.5.2.1 Proof load. The tongs shall be subjected to lifting the type of item for which it was designed to lift, weighted to 2-1/2 times its respective rated capacity (SWL) specified in 1.2. This proof test shall be conducted by applying a vertical hoisting force to the lifting ring or shackle, as applicable for type I, II, III or V tongs, or via the rollers for type IV tongs, until the proof load is lifted free of any support. Nonconformance to 3.6 shall constitute failure of this test.

4.5.2.2 Repetitive/sustained loads (SWL). The tongs shall be subjected to lifting, repeatedly, their respective rated capacity loads (SWL). The test shall be conducted similarly as for the proof-load test except that the lifted load shall be the tong's rated capacity load (SWL) specified in 1.2 and that the load shall be lifted 10 times with the load to be suspended (unsupported) 5 minutes each time it is lifted. Nonconformance to 3.6 shall constitute failure of this test.

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4.6 Inspection of packaging.

4.6.1 Quality conformance inspection of packaging.

4.6.1.1 Unit of product. For the purpose of inspection, a complete pack prepared for shipment shall be considered a unit of product.

4.6.1.2 Sampling. Sampling for examination shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.6.1.3 Examination. Samples selected in accordance with 4.6.1.2 shall be examined for applicable defects listed in table III. AQL shall be 2.5 percent defective.

TABLE III. Examination.

No.	Defect	A	B	Commercial
113.	Tongs not cleaned as specified.	5.1.1		5.1.2
114.	Tongs not coated as specified.	5.1.1		5.1.2
115.	Tongs not wrapped as specified.	5.1.1		5.1.2
116.	Shipping container not as specified.	5.2.1	5.2.2	5.2.3
117.	Shipping container exceeds weight limitation.	5.2.1	5.2.2	5.2.3
118.	Round wire strapping used instead of flat strapping.	5.2.1	5.2.2	5.2.3
119.	Unitization not as specified.	5.2.4	5.2.4	5.2.4
120.	Wrapped tongs not marked as specified.	5.3.1		5.3.2
121.	Shipping containers not marked as specified.	5.3.1	5.3.1	5.3.2

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5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. The tongs shall be cleaned by method C-1 and coated with type P-1 preservative in accordance with MIL-P-116. Each tong shall then be wrapped with waterproof, greaseproof barrier material conforming to MIL-B-121, type I, grade A, class 2. The wrap shall be secured with pressure sensitive tape conforming to PPP-T-60, type IV.

5.1.2 Commercial. The tongs shall be preserved in accordance with MIL-STD-1188.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, level B or commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. The tongs, preserved as specified in 5.1.1, shall be packed in overseas type, wood, cleated plywood boxes conforming to PPP-B-601, grade B, style optional, or overseas class, nailed, wood boxes conforming to PPP-B-621, style optional. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix to the applicable specification except that round wire shall not be used. The gross weight of the box shall not exceed 200 pounds.

5.2.2 Level B. The tongs, preserved as specified in 5.1.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1 for level A, except that boxes shall be domestic type or class, as applicable.

5.2.3 Commercial. The tongs, preserved as specified in 5.1.2 shall be packed in accordance with MIL-STD-1188.

5.2.4 Unitized loads. Unitized loads, appropriate for the type of shipping container and the degree of packing specified in the contract or purchase order, shall be used whenever the total quantity of a single size tong for shipment to one destination equals 40 cubic feet or more. Quantities less than 40 cubic feet need not be unitized. Unitized loads shall be uniform in size and quantities to the greatest extent practicable, with only one type and class per load.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Levels A and B. In addition to any special or other identification marking required by the contract (see 6.2), each wrapped tong, each exterior container and unitized load if applicable, shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

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5.3.2 Commercial. Commercial marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-1188.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Material lifting tongs are lifting devices intended to be used with cranes or other hoisting equipment for lifting and moving beams, rails, barrels, boxes, and timber.

6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.

b. Definitive military specification part number required (see 1.2, 3.1, 6.6).

c. When a first article is required for inspection and approval and number of units required (see 3.2).

d. Degree of preservation and degree of packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).

e. Any special marking instruction (see 5.3.1).

6.3 First article. When a first article inspection is required, the item will be tested and should be a preproduction model. The first article should consist of one or more units. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for examinations, test approval of the document's first article.

6.4 Information figures. Figures 1 through 6 show types of tongs which have been found acceptable; however, the figures are included for illustration only and are not intended to preclude the furnishing of other tongs which conform to this specification.

6.5 Recycled material. It is encouraged that recycled material be used, when practical, as long as it meets the requirements of this specification (see 3.3).

6.6 Definitive military specification part number. The military specification part number is a definitive part number which corresponds to the type code

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number and class code letter of the tongs covered by this specification. The specification number, the type code number and the class code letter are combined to form the definitive military specification part number.

Custodians:
Army - ME
Air Force - 99

Preparing activity:
Army - ME

Review activity:
DLA - IS

Project 3940-0166

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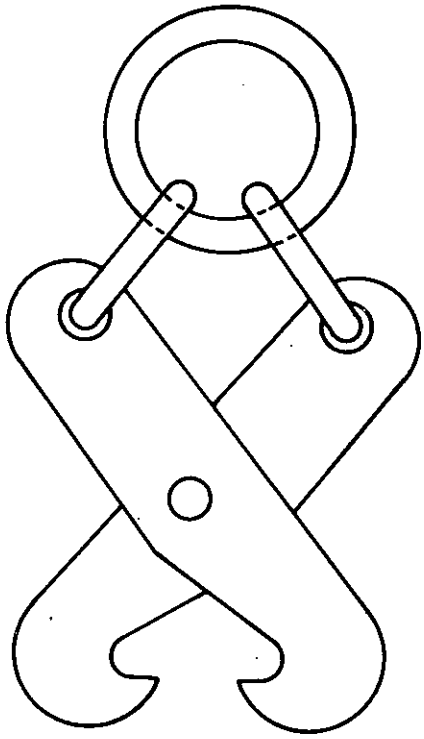


FIGURE 1. Type I, I-beam lifting tongs.

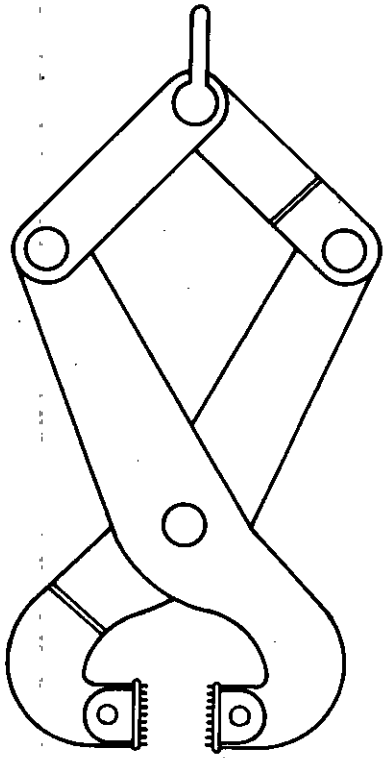
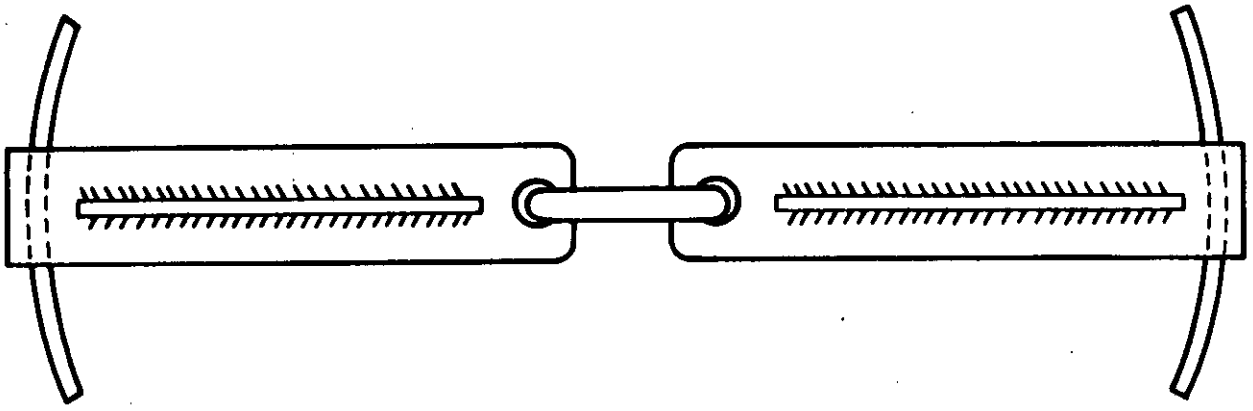


FIGURE 2. Type II, rail lifting tongs.

X-2991A

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TOP VIEW



SIDE VIEW

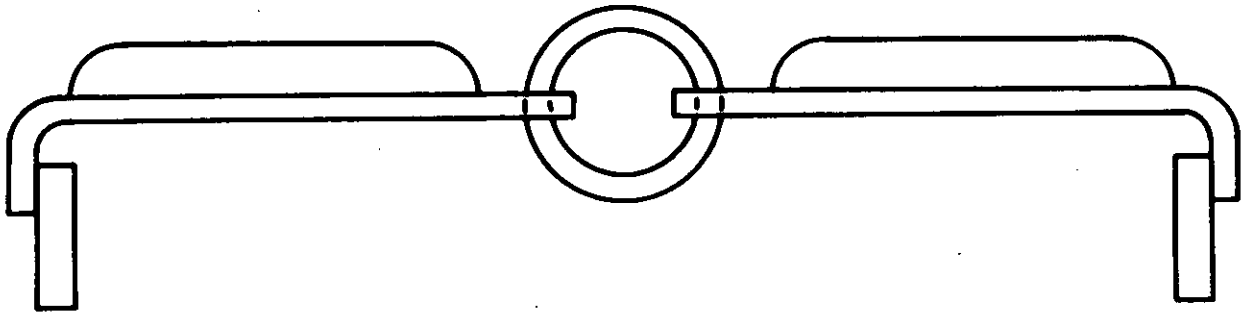


FIGURE 3. Type III, barrel lifting tongs.

X-2992B

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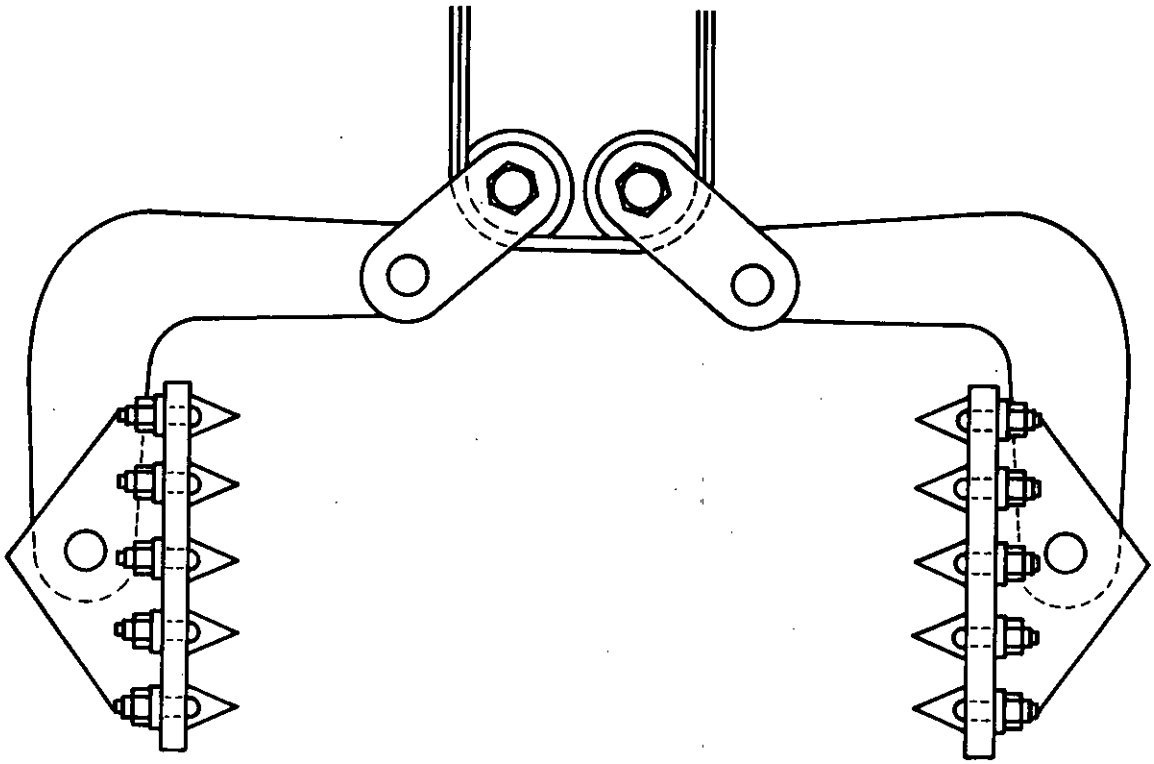


FIGURE 4. Type IV, box lifting tongs.

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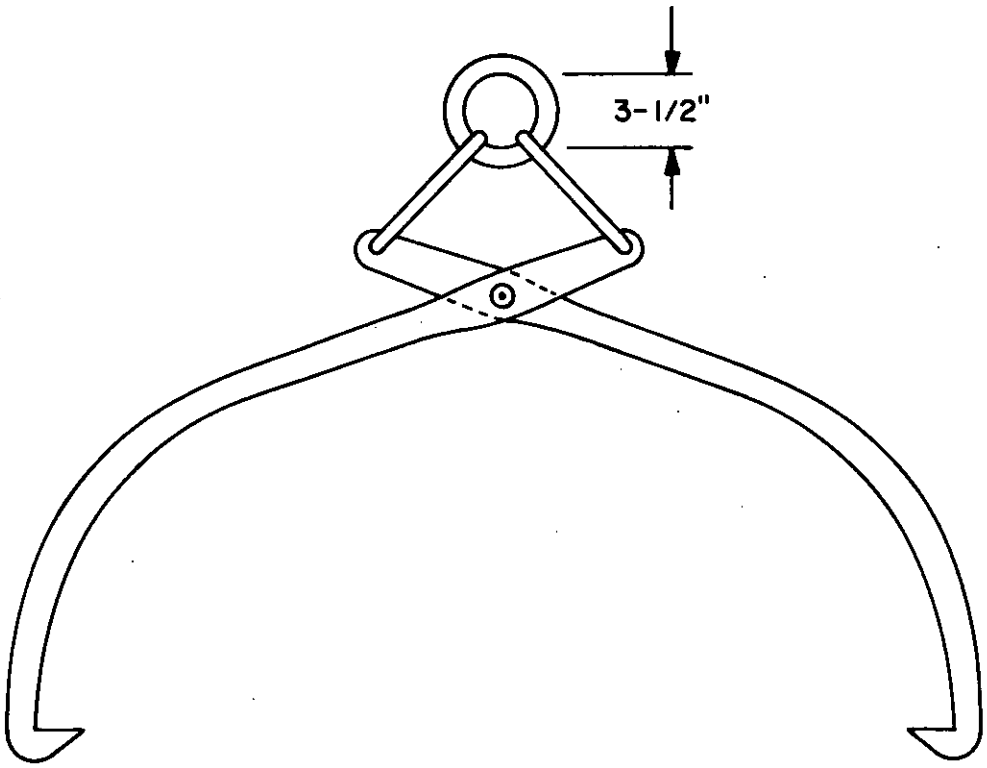


FIGURE 5. Type V, class I timber lifting tongs.

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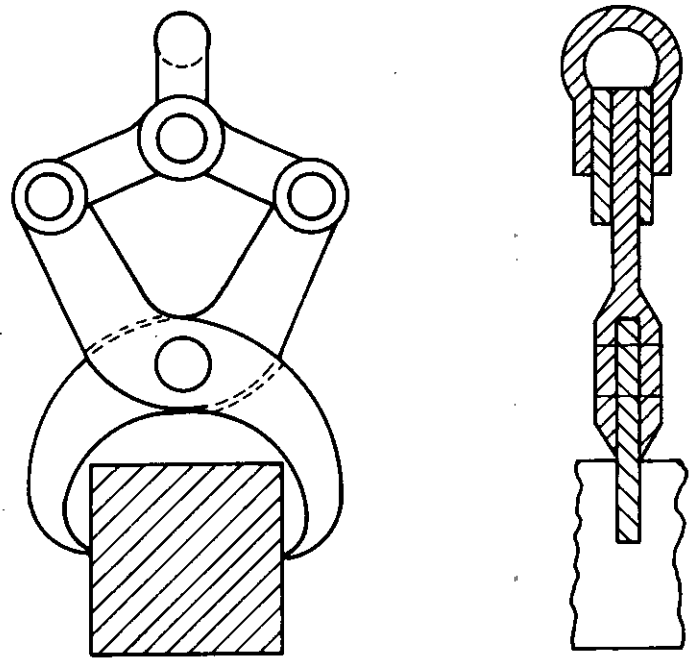


FIGURE 6, Type V, class 2, timber lifting tongs.

X-2995A

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